My First API GET Workflow

Step 1: Install and Configure Postman

Postman is an industry-standard API client used for building, testing, and debugging API calls:

1. Open your web browser and navigate to https://www.postman.com/downloads/.
2. Download and run the installer for your operating system.
3. Open the Postman application and sign up for a free personal account.
4. Once logged in, click on the **Workspaces** dropdown menu in the top navigation bar and select **Create Workspace**.
5. Configure the workspace settings:
    a. **Name:** `n8n_API_Trainee_Workspace`
    b. **Visibility:** Select **Personal** (private to you).
6. Click **Create Workspace** to initialize your development canvas.

Step 2: Set Up Your n8n Environment (Local or Cloud)uu

You can choose to run n8n either in the cloud or self-hosted locally on your machine. Choose one of the options below:

Option A: n8n Cloud (Recommended for quick start)

1. Go to https://n8n.io/cloud/ and sign up for a free developer trial account.
2. Complete the initial registration email verification.
3. Launch your editor workspace from the cloud portal (e.g. https://your-subdomain.n8n.cloud).

Option B: Local npm Setup (Alternative)

1. Ensure you have Node.js (v18.x or newer) installed on your machine.
2. Open your terminal or PowerShell and run the command to install n8n globally:`npm install n8n -g`

3. Launch n8n locally by running:`n8n start`

4. Once initialized, open your browser and go to http://localhost:5678. Set up your admin login details.

Step 3: Identify the Public Mock API Sandbox

To test requests safely without API keys or registrations, we will use **JSONPlaceholder**, a free online REST API sandbox representing mock server records:

- **Base URL Endpoint:** https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com
- **Resource Route:** `/users` (returns a list of 10 mock user profiles)
- **Target Method:** `GET`
- **Resulting URI:** `GET` https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com/users

Step 4: Execute Your First GET Request in Postman

1. In Postman, click the **+** tab in the center panel to open a new request canvas.
2. Set the HTTP request method dropdown (located left of the URL bar) to **GET** (default setting).
3. Paste the sandbox URL in the address bar: https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com/users
4. Click the blue **Send** button on the right.
5. Review the results in the response dashboard at the bottom:
    a. **Status Code:** Confirm it shows `200 OK` (successful request).
    b. **Time & Size:** Observe the response transit time (ms) and data size.
    c. **Body Tab:** Set the output filter to **JSON** (or Pretty) to view the list of mock user profiles (including parameters like id, name, email, address).

Step 5: Build and Run Your GET Workflow in n8n

1. Open your n8n visual editor page in the browser.
2. Click **+ Add First Step** or **+** in the center of the blank canvas.
3. Select **Manual Trigger** node from the triggers category.
4. Hover over the right output port of the Manual Trigger node, click the **+** connector, and search for the **HTTP Request** node.
5. Click **HTTP Request** to add and connect the node.
6. Double-click the **HTTP Request** node to open its configuration panel:
    a. **Method:** Select `GET` from the dropdown list.
    b. **URL:** Paste: https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com/users
    c. **Authentication:** Set to `None`.
    d. **Response Format:** Set to `JSON` (default setting).
7. Inside the HTTP Request node panel, click the **Test step** or **Listen for test** button.
8. Inspect the response panel on the right. Confirm the JSON data returns successfully with the array of mock user records.

Step 6: Naming, Saving, and Executing the Workflow

1. Click on the default workflow name (top-left corner, e.g., "My workflow 1") and rename it to: `My First API GET Workflow`
2. Click the **Save** button in the top-right corner of the canvas.
3. Click the **Test workflow** button located at the bottom-center of the screen.

4. Observe the execution details: a green checkmark will appear next to both the **Manual Trigger** and **HTTP Request** nodes, indicating that data flowed successfully without errors.